THE NEXT 100

POLITICS

JAT ENGINE

DUSHYANT CHAUTALA, 33

Deputy Chief Minister, Haryana



SANDEEP SAHDEV

His is the only political family—apart from the famed Gandhis—that has contributed four generations of elected leaders. Yet, Dushyant Chautala, the deputy chief minister of Haryana and president and co-founder of the Janata Jannayak Party (JJP), has time and again demonstrated that he can negotiate political battlefields without invoking family legacy. Even before he was eligible to contest election, Dushyant had in 2013 told india today that "winning people's hearts is not an easy job". Understanding the pulse of the public comes naturally to someone who was only eight when he accompanied great-grandfather and former deputy prime minister Devi Lal on his campaign trail in Rohtak in 1996.

In 2014, Dushyant became the youngest member of the 16th Lok Sabha, winning at a time when his grandfather and former Haryana chief minister Om Prakash Chautala, his father Ajay Singh Chautala and uncle Abhay Singh Chautala were in jail. Four years later, as his differences with his grandfather and uncle grew, Dushyant was expelled from the Indian National Lok Dal (INLD). Undeterred, he went on to form a party of his own at age 31, which won 10 seats in its very first electoral outing—the 2019 Haryana assembly election—while the INLD won just one seat. With the BJP six seats short of a majority in the 90-member house, Dushyant joined them in exchange for the deputy chief minister's post and several key portfolios for JJP. He has since been using his stint in power to consolidate his position as the next big leader of the Jats, who often determine electoral outcomes in Haryana.

– Kaushik Deka

DEGREE AND PEDIGREEE

After a BSc in business administration from CSU, Bakersfield, Dushyant did LLM (Prof.) from National Law University, Delhi, in 2018 followed next year by mass communication from Guru Jambheshwar University of Science & Technology, Hisar

"Instead of banking on his family legacy, Dushyant has worked hard to become a true representative of the people. From meeting common citizens daily to dealing with senior officials, he stays calm and gives personal attention to every public grievance or government file"

DR K.C. BANGAR,
Sr National Vice-president, JJP, ex-Chairman, Haryana Public Service Commission